Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-11

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 5:7-17

7 You who turn justice to wormwood, And lay righteousness to rest in the earth!”

8 He made the Pleiades and Orion; He turns the shadow of death into morning And makes the day dark as night; He calls for the waters of the sea And pours them out on the face of the earth; The LORD is His name.

9 He rains ruin upon the strong, So that fury comes upon the fortress.

10 They hate the one who rebukes in the gate, And they abhor the one who speaks uprightly.

11 Therefore, because you tread down the poor And take grain taxes from him, Though you have built houses of hewn stone, Yet you shall not dwell in them; You have planted pleasant vineyards, But you shall not drink wine from them.

12 For I know your manifold transgressions And your mighty sins: Afflicting the just and taking bribes; Diverting the poor from justice at the gate.

13 Therefore the prudent keep silent at that time, For it is an evil time.

14 Seek good and not evil, That you may live; So the LORD God of hosts will be with you, As you have spoken.

15 Hate evil, love good; Establish justice in the gate. It may be that the LORD God of hosts Will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph.

16 Therefore the LORD God of hosts, the Lord, says this: “There shall be wailing in all streets, And they shall say in all the highways, ‘Alas! Alas!’ They shall call the farmer to mourning, And skillful lamenters to wailing.

17 In all vineyards there shall be wailing, For I will pass through you,” Says the LORD.

II. Key Summary

• Verses 7–9 speak of those who turn justice to wormwood and lay righteousness to rest in the earth, and point to the LORD who made the Pleiades and Orion, who turns the shadow of death into morning and makes the day dark as night, and who rains ruin upon the strong.

• Verses 10–13 say they hate the one who rebukes in the gate and abhor the one who speaks uprightly; they tread down the poor, take bribes, and divert the poor from justice at the gate. They have built houses of hewn stone but shall not dwell in them, and planted pleasant vineyards but shall not drink wine from them; the prudent keep silent at that time, for it is an evil time.

• Verses 14–17 call them to seek good and not evil, to hate evil, love good, and establish justice in the gate, for it may be that the LORD will be gracious to the remnant of Joseph; the LORD also says there shall be wailing in all streets and vineyards, for He will pass through them.

III. Passage Analysis

"They Hate the One Who Rebukes in the Gate"

> "The gate": the place for business and for judging cases. "The one who speaks uprightly": refers to an honest witness or judge. [1]

The gate was where people came to settle what was right, but in verse 10 they hate the one who rebukes there and abhor the one who speaks uprightly; in verse 12, at the same gate, they take bribes and divert the poor from justice.

The gate that should have upheld justice became the place where the poor were wronged.

"Establish Justice in the Gate"

> Amos proclaimed God's cure for Israel's sin. They must begin to simply seek good and not evil. They must transform their corrupt courts and establish justice in the gate. [2]

In verse 15, "Hate evil, love good; establish justice in the gate" points back to the same gate as verses 10 and 12.

What God wanted them to change was right in the place where they had wronged the

poor.

IV. Reflection Question

If speaking uprightly for someone around you who has been falsely blamed would make everyone dislike you, would you still stand up for them?

At Israel's gate, the one who speaks uprightly was abhorred and the poor were diverted from justice (vv. 10, 12); the LORD told them to "establish justice in the gate" (v. 15). Wherever God passes through, no one can escape (v. 17) [3].

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chain-Reference Bible Commentary (串珠聖經註釋), Amos 5 notes, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT05.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Amos 5 – The Offerings God Hates, https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/amos-5/

[3] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Chinese Study Bible notes (啟導本註釋), Amos 5 notes, https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT05.htm